

YEAR 1 BUDGET

# TURNING THE TIDES

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## FINANCIAL PLAN

FOUNDER: JOHN COLLINS  
MAUI, HAWAII • A 501(C)(3) IN FORMATION  
MAY 2026

# Year 1 Overview

TOTAL YEAR 1 BUDGET

\$92,900

Funding 3 pilot retreats (3-5 days each) serving 18 combat veterans (lodging donated by partner)

| Category                    | Amount   | % of Budget |
|-----------------------------|----------|-------------|
| Startup & Legal Costs       | \$3,990  | 4.3%        |
| Insurance & Compliance      | \$4,800  | 5.2%        |
| 3 Pilot Retreats (3-5 days) | \$32,400 | 34.9%       |
| Operations & Personnel      | \$33,900 | 36.5%       |
| Marketing & Development     | \$5,700  | 6.1%        |
| Contingency (15%)           | \$12,119 | 13.0%       |
| TOTAL                       | \$92,909 | 100%        |

## How Funds Reach Veterans

More than 60% of every dollar goes directly toward retreat operations and veteran services. The remaining funds support the infrastructure, insurance, and personnel that make those retreats possible safely and at scale.

## Cost Per Veteran Served

| Year            | Veterans Served | Cost per Veteran |
|-----------------|-----------------|------------------|
| Year 1 (Pilot)  | 18              | \$5,161          |
| Year 3 (Scale)  | 48              | \$5,200          |
| Year 5 (Mature) | 72              | \$5,500          |

For comparison, the VA spends approximately \$11,000 per year on outpatient PTSD care for a single veteran.

## DETAILED LINE ITEMS

# Startup & Compliance

## Startup Costs

| Line Item                            | Qty   | Unit Cost | Total          |
|--------------------------------------|-------|-----------|----------------|
| 501(c)(3) IRS Filing Fee             | 1     | \$600     | \$600          |
| Hawaii Incorporation                 | 1     | \$50      | \$50           |
| EIN Application                      | 1     | \$0       | \$0            |
| Legal consultation (nonprofit setup) | 5 hr  | \$200     | \$1,000        |
| Bookkeeping software (QuickBooks)    | 12 mo | \$30      | \$360          |
| CPA review & setup                   | 1     | \$1,500   | \$1,500        |
| Website hosting & domain             | 12 mo | \$15      | \$180          |
| Logo / branding refinement           | 1     | \$300     | \$300          |
| <b>SUBTOTAL — STARTUP</b>            |       |           | <b>\$3,990</b> |

## Insurance & Compliance

| Line Item                     | Qty   | Unit Cost | Total          |
|-------------------------------|-------|-----------|----------------|
| General Liability Insurance   | 12 mo | \$200     | \$2,400        |
| Directors & Officers (D&O)    | 12 mo | \$150     | \$1,800        |
| Participant Accident Coverage | 12 mo | \$50      | \$600          |
| <b>SUBTOTAL — INSURANCE</b>   |       |           | <b>\$4,800</b> |

*Insurance is non-negotiable. Without it, no liability protection for John, the board, or the program. Insurance quotes vary by state — Hawaii rates may differ. Get 2-3 quotes before locking in.*

## DETAILED LINE ITEMS

# Per-Retreat Cost Breakdown

Each retreat hosts ~6 veterans for 3-5 days. Costs scale linearly — a 4-vet retreat is cheaper, an 8-vet retreat is more expensive. Shorter retreats lower the barrier to attendance for veterans with jobs, families, or limited PTO.

## Single Retreat (6 vets × 4 days)

| Line Item                           | Qty       | Unit Cost | Total           |
|-------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|-----------------|
| Round-trip flights to Maui          | 6         | \$700     | \$4,200         |
| Ground transport on Maui            | 1         | \$500     | \$500           |
| Lodging — <i>donated by partner</i> | 24 nights | \$0       | \$0             |
| Groceries & meals                   | 24 days   | \$50      | \$1,200         |
| Surf instruction                    | 6         | \$150     | \$900           |
| Snorkel rental & guides             | 1         | \$400     | \$400           |
| Hiking transport & permits          | 1         | \$300     | \$300           |
| Cultural practitioner stipends      | 1         | \$500     | \$500           |
| Park fees & permits                 | 1         | \$200     | \$200           |
| Facilitator stipend                 | 1         | \$1,200   | \$1,200         |
| Local helpers / volunteers          | 1         | \$400     | \$400           |
| Farm supplies & gear                | 1         | \$300     | \$300           |
| First aid / safety equipment        | 1         | \$200     | \$200           |
| Per-retreat contingency             | 1         | \$500     | \$500           |
| <b>COST PER RETREAT</b>             |           |           | <b>\$10,800</b> |

YEAR 1 TOTAL — 3 RETREATS

**\$32,400**

Approximately \$1,800 per veteran in direct retreat costs (lodging donated)

## DETAILED LINE ITEMS

# Operations & Marketing

## Operations & Personnel

| Line Item                        | Qty     | Unit Cost | Total           |
|----------------------------------|---------|-----------|-----------------|
| Founder / ED stipend (part-time) | 12 mo   | \$2,500   | \$30,000        |
| Phone & internet                 | 12 mo   | \$100     | \$1,200         |
| Software subscriptions           | 12 mo   | \$50      | \$600           |
| Office supplies & postage        | 1       | \$500     | \$500           |
| Founder travel (mainland ↔ Maui) | 2 trips | \$800     | \$1,600         |
| <b>SUBTOTAL — OPERATIONS</b>     |         |           | <b>\$33,900</b> |

## Marketing & Development

| Line Item                              | Qty    | Unit Cost | Total          |
|----------------------------------------|--------|-----------|----------------|
| Crowdfunding platform fees             | 1      | \$500     | \$500          |
| Print materials (brochures, cards)     | 1      | \$500     | \$500          |
| Photography / videography              | 2 days | \$750     | \$1,500        |
| Veteran outreach (events, conferences) | 1      | \$1,000   | \$1,000        |
| Social media boosted posts             | 12 mo  | \$100     | \$1,200        |
| Donor cultivation events               | 2      | \$500     | \$1,000        |
| <b>SUBTOTAL — MARKETING</b>            |        |           | <b>\$5,700</b> |

## Contingency

15% of total budget held in reserve for unforeseen costs, emergency travel, equipment repair, or opportunity grants. Industry standard for early-stage nonprofits.

|                                   |                 |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------|
| <b>Year 1 Contingency Reserve</b> | <b>\$12,119</b> |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------|

# Revenue Sources

## Year 1 Funding Targets

| Source                     | Probability | Target           | Conservative    |
|----------------------------|-------------|------------------|-----------------|
| Foundation Grants          | Medium      | \$60,000         | \$30,000        |
| Individual Donations       | High        | \$25,000         | \$15,000        |
| Corporate Sponsorships     | Medium      | \$20,000         | \$10,000        |
| Crowdfunding Launch        | High        | \$15,000         | \$10,000        |
| Founder / Personal Capital | Confirmed   | \$10,000         | \$10,000        |
| <b>TOTAL</b>               |             | <b>\$130,000</b> | <b>\$75,000</b> |

## Specific Grant Targets

| Grant Source               | Focus               | Range         |
|----------------------------|---------------------|---------------|
| Bob Woodruff Foundation    | Veteran wellness    | \$10k - \$50k |
| Gary Sinise Foundation     | Veteran support     | \$10k - \$25k |
| Semper Fi & America's Fund | Combat veterans     | \$10k - \$30k |
| USDA Rural Development     | Agriculture / rural | varies        |
| Local Hawaii Foundations   | Community-based     | \$5k - \$20k  |

*First-year nonprofits typically secure 40-60% of their target funding. The "Conservative" column above reflects a realistic worst-case scenario — even at this level, the program can run 2 retreats and serve 12 veterans.*

## LONG-TERM PROJECTION

# 5-Year Outlook

This projection assumes successful execution of Year 1, modest grant growth, and the addition of paid civilian wellness retreats as a revenue stream beginning in Year 2.

| Year                | Retreats  | Veterans Served | Annual Budget  | Revenue Goal   |
|---------------------|-----------|-----------------|----------------|----------------|
| Year 1 (Pilot)      | 3         | 18              | \$92,900       | \$120,000      |
| Year 2 (Build)      | 5         | 30              | \$175,000      | \$200,000      |
| Year 3 (Scale)      | 8         | 48              | \$250,000      | \$280,000      |
| Year 4              | 10        | 60              | \$325,000      | \$360,000      |
| Year 5 (Mature)     | 12        | 72              | \$400,000      | \$440,000      |
| <b>5-YEAR TOTAL</b> | <b>38</b> | <b>~228</b>     | <b>\$1.24M</b> | <b>\$1.40M</b> |

## Strategic Milestones

| Year   | Key Milestones                                                                                                     |
|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Year 1 | 501(c)(3) granted, 3 pilot retreats, board recruited, alumni network started                                       |
| Year 2 | Civilian wellness retreats launched, part-time program director hired, 3-month operating reserve achieved          |
| Year 3 | Permanent guest cabins built, full-time program staff, audited financials, signature annual fundraising event      |
| Year 4 | National alumni mentorship program, second retreat location explored                                               |
| Year 5 | Endowment fund established, 200+ veterans served lifetime, recognized as leading veteran retreat program in Hawaii |

FOR DONORS & FUNDERS

# Every Dollar Reaches A Veteran.

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Turning the Tides is committed to transparency in every dollar spent. Annual financial reports will be published publicly. Audited financials beginning Year 3.

JOHN COLLINS

FOUNDER, TURNING THE TIDES

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